

The problem, how we'd solve it, and the numbers.

Centered on the problem statement you and Matt laid out — the cost of running fitting on a custom-built system, how Shopify POS solves it, and what it costs.

01 THE PROBLEM — THE COST OF A CUSTOM-BUILT SYSTEM

True Spec's fitting business — 41 locations — runs entirely on a custom-built POS (ADS); the Shopify Advanced store is just a small merch shop. ADS exists for one reason: years ago Shopify POS couldn't capture fitting specs on line items, so fitters were stuck in Google Sheets and you built your own system to escape it. That fix now carries ongoing cost and risk:

- **Every upgrade is yours to build** — new features, fixes, and integrations are all custom dev work, on your timeline and budget. Tech debt compounds year over year.
- **A brittle, stitched-together stack** — ADS + SKU Vault + Salesforce + ShipStation + Avalara + an external payment portal → phantom POs, split-shipments, double-ships, constant reconciliation, no single customer record.
- **Security & PCI sit with you** — a custom payment path is yours to patch, certify, and keep compliant.
- **You miss the platform's innovation** — every Shopify POS release (payment links, Tap to Pay, endless aisle, the Spring '26 updates) is something you'd have to build yourself, if at all.

02 HOW WE'D SOLVE IT — COME BACK TO A PLATFORM THAT MAINTAINS ITSELF

The reason you left is gone: Shopify POS now captures custom specs natively on line items — Chris Cote's Golf runs exactly this fitting workflow today. So you can drop the custom-system burden and let the platform do the upkeep.

- ▶ **Native spec capture on POS line items** — the Google-sheet workaround that forced the ADS build is solved; POS v11 is ~73s faster per complex cart.
- ▶ **No more building your own upgrades** — platform improvements, security, and PCI are handled, and new POS features ship to you automatically.
- ▶ **Fitting + checkout in one system** — ends the phantom POs, double-ships, and reconciliation the stitched stack creates.
- ▶ **Payment links + lower card rates** — recover post-fitting deals; POS Pro included across all 41 locations on Plus.

Why Plus, and why it's low-lift: POS Pro is included on Plus at every location — à la carte that's ~\$89/mo per store (~\$44K/yr across your 41) — so the \$2,300/mo license covers POS everywhere, plus upgrades, security, and the lowest card rates. You already run Shopify for merch, so it's a familiar platform. Phased and non-disruptive: **stand up POS for fitting (read-only sync to ADS / SKU Vault) → pilot a few locations side-by-side → roll out across all 41, retiring ADS on your timeline.**

+ NEW IN SPRING '26 POS — INCLUDED, NOT CUSTOM-BUILT

- ▶ **Endless aisle / ship-to-customer** — sell any club, head, or shaft from the full catalog and ship it when a location's out of stock. Capture the walk-out sale.
- ▶ **Tap to Pay across locations** — contactless payment on a phone anywhere on the floor; also trims hardware.
- ▶ **Online → in-person via Shop app** — send local Shop shoppers to the nearest store; online demand becomes foot traffic.
- ▶ **Returns & exchanges in one cart** — refund, exchange, and new sale together, keeping the customer in the chair.

03 THE MONEY

Illustrative model — figures use industry benchmarks and what you shared on our calls. Tell me which numbers to swap in (below) and the math holds.

ANNUAL COST	TODAY (ADS + ADVANCED MERCH)	SHOPIFY POS (PLUS)
ADS dev + maintenance (custom system)	\$60,000	\$30,000 reduced
Card processing (~\$19.5M volume)	\$565,500 @2.9%	\$487,500 @2.5%
Platform license (Plus adds POS Pro, all 41)	\$4,800 Advanced	\$27,600 Plus
Annual operating total	\$630,300	\$545,100
Recurring operating savings / yr		+\$85,200
+ One-time: implementation (setup + ADS integration)	—	\$30,000
+ One-time: POS hardware (~58 fitters)	—	\$11,000

The cost that isn't in the table: on ADS, staying current is continuous custom dev — every new feature, integration, and security patch is your build and your budget, and tech debt compounds. On Plus, upgrades, PCI/security, and new POS features are included. That "keep-up" cost grows every year you stay custom — and it's the real reason to move.

OPERATING SAVINGS / YR

ADS custom dev/maintenance reduced ~50%	+\$30,000
Card processing (2.9% → 2.5%)	+\$78,000
Ops time — 10 hrs/wk (Cote's, @\$40/hr)	+\$20,800
Less: incremental license (Advanced → Plus)	-\$22,800
Net recurring savings	≈ \$106,000

REVENUE LIFT / YR (conservative)

Recovered post-fitting deals via payment links	+\$75,000
Endless aisle — ship out-of-stock from full catalog	upside
Faster checkout → more fitting capacity	upside
Cote's Golf: ~50% less custom-order processing time on this workflow.	

NET RECURRING SAVINGS

~\$106K/yr

Before revenue lift & avoided build cost

YEAR-1 ONE-TIME COST

~\$41K

\$30K setup + \$11K hardware

PAYBACK

~5 mo

Savings cover implementation

If it's worth a look: let me know which numbers to swap in — your ADS dev + maintenance spend, card rate + payment-portal fees, and annual card volume — and we can review the real TCO together.